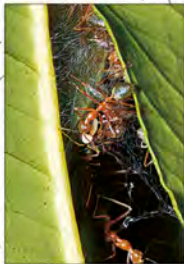


ANTS



Weaving away
Weaver ants make their nests in trees. They sew leaves together using a sticky silk thread produced by their larvae. The queen lives inside the leaf envelope.



Farming fungus
Leafcutter ants are the farmers of the ant world. They cut up bits of leaf and take them back to the nest. Fungus grows on the rotting leaf—and then the ants feed on the fungus!

Ants live together in nests that are like underground towns. There may be millions of ants living in one nest. Most of these are female and are called workers. Some workers build and repair the nest, while some are “soldiers” and guard the entrance. Others gather food for the larvae and the huge queen. Her life is spent laying millions of eggs, and the survival of the nest depends upon her well-being.

Ants have powerful jaws, or mandibles, for chopping food. Their mouth is just below the mandibles.

Some ants will spray a nasty chemical from their rear end if they sense danger!

When ants meet they “tap” antennae. The antennae contain chemical “messages” which can be passed on by touching.

Ants can run very fast because they have long legs.